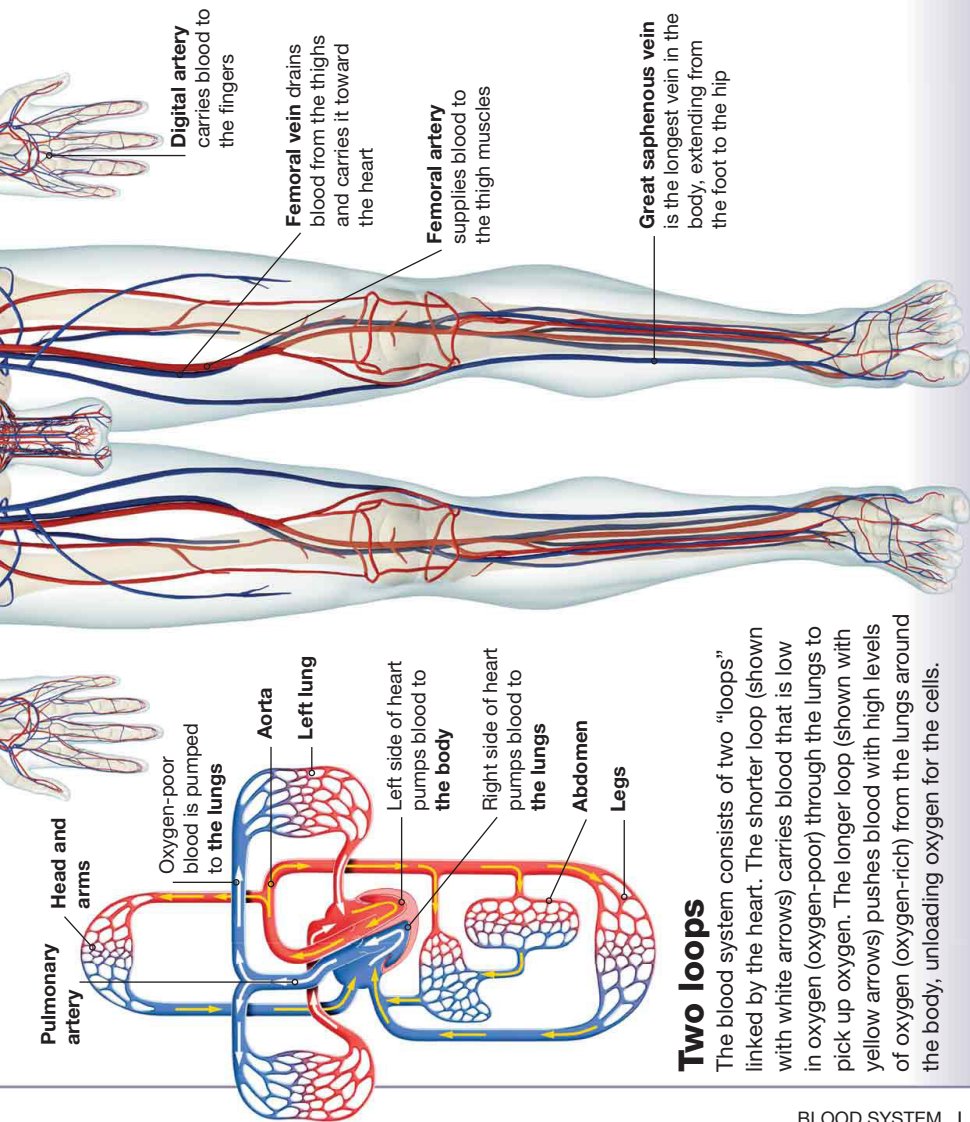




Two loops

The blood system consists of two “loops” linked by the heart. The shorter loop (shown with white arrows) carries blood that is low in oxygen (oxygen-poor) through the lungs to pick up oxygen. The longer loop (shown with yellow arrows) pushes blood with high levels of oxygen (oxygen-rich) from the lungs around the body, unloading oxygen for the cells.